



**CEBU INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY**  
**U N I V E R S I T Y**

# IT334 - G01

---

## **SWOT ANALYSIS REPORT**

### **Blocknotes**

---

Members:

Jose Raphael Lawas– BSIT - 4

Jessie Noel D. Lapure– BSIT - 4

Nathan Xander Lada– BSIT - 4

Clarence Kirk Macapobre– BSIT - 4

Date: 11/26/2025

Table 1. Summary of the SWOT Analysis

| STRENGTHS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | WEAKNESSES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Premium "Web3" Aesthetic: Distinctive glassmorphic design that stands out from standard flat-design competitors.</li> <li>2. Enhanced Performance: Removing blockchain transactions eliminates latency, resulting in instant, snappy interactions.</li> <li>3. Strict Data Privacy: User isolation is enforced; users only see their own notes, ensuring complete privacy and security.</li> <li>4. Comprehensive Productivity Suite: Full feature set (Pin, Archive, Trash, Color-coding) meets all standard user needs out of the box.</li> </ol> | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Centralized Data Storage: Unlike the previous version, data is stored in a standard database, losing the "immutability" selling point.</li> <li>2. Dependency on Google OAuth: User access is entirely dependent on Google's authentication service availability and policies.</li> <li>3. Limited Offline Capability: As a web-based cloud app, it requires an active internet connection for full functionality (unlike local-first apps).</li> <li>4. Single-Player Focus: Currently lacks real-time collaboration or sharing features found in major competitors.</li> </ol> |
| OPPORTUNITIES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | THREATS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. AI Integration: With text stored in a standard DB, it's easy to add AI features like auto-summarization or content generation.</li> <li>2. Cross-Platform PWA: The responsive design can be easily converted into a Progressive Web App (PWA) for mobile stores.</li> <li>3. Collaborative Features: Opportunity to add "Shared Folders" or "Team Workspaces" for enterprise users.</li> <li>4. Freemium Model: The premium look allows for monetization strategies like "Pro Themes" or increased storage limits.</li> </ol>                       | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Market Saturation: Direct competition with giants like Notion, Keep, and Apple Notes who offer similar features for free.</li> <li>2. Data Breach Risks: Centralized databases are attractive targets for hackers; a breach could compromise all user notes.</li> <li>3. Browser Performance: Heavy use of glassmorphism (backdrop-filter) can drain battery and lag on older low-end devices.</li> <li>4. Platform Dependency: Changes to Google's OAuth API or pricing could disrupt the login flow or increase operational costs.</li> </ol>                                  |

# I. STRENGTHS

In this section, we analyze the internal positive attributes that give the app a competitive advantage.

- **Premium "Web3" Aesthetic:** The application retains the high-end "Glassmorphism" look (frosted glass, neon accents, dark mode) associated with modern Web3 dApps. This gives it a unique visual identity that feels futuristic and expensive compared to the boring, white-and-grey designs of standard note apps.
- **Enhanced Performance:** By removing the dependency on blockchain transactions (which can take 15-30 seconds to confirm), the app now offers a "Real-Time" experience. Creating, pinning, and deleting notes happens instantly, providing the snappy feedback loop that productivity users demand.
- **Strict Data Privacy:** The pivot to a standard Web2 architecture with Google OAuth allows for robust user isolation. Unlike the previous demo version where data might have been visible on a public ledger, now every database query is strictly filtered by the authenticated user, ensuring total privacy.
- **Comprehensive Productivity Suite:** The "Quick Wins" implementation provided a complete toolset. Users don't need to wait for updates to get essential features like Pinning important tasks, Archiving clutter, recovering from Trash, or Color-coding for organization. It is feature-complete for daily use.

## II. WEAKNESSES

In this section, we analyze the internal negative attributes that place the app at a disadvantage.

- **Centralized Data Storage:** We have traded "Immutability" for "Speed." The notes now live in a standard SQL database. This means the data is mutable and theoretically vulnerable to server-side alteration or loss if backups fail, unlike the permanent record of a blockchain.
- **Dependency on Google OAuth:** The app relies 100% on Google for identity management. If a user loses access to their Google account, or if Google changes their API terms, users could be locked out. It lacks a fallback "Email/Password" login method.
- **Limited Offline Capability:** While the UI might show cached data, the app is fundamentally "Cloud-First." Without an internet connection, users cannot save new notes to the server or sync changes, putting it at a disadvantage compared to "Local-First" apps like Obsidian.
- **Single-Player Focus:** The current architecture is designed for individual use. There is no infrastructure for real-time collaboration (like Google Docs) or sharing read-only links, which limits its appeal for teams or families.

### III. OPPORTUNITIES

In this section, we analyze external factors that the app could exploit to its advantage.

1. **AI Integration:** Since the data is now standard text in a database (and not locked in smart contracts), it is trivial to integrate LLMs (like Gemini or GPT). We could add features like "Summarize this note," "Fix grammar," or "Generate ideas," turning it into an AI-powered workspace.
2. **Cross-Platform PWA:** The responsive web design is already mobile-friendly. Packaging this as a Progressive Web App (PWA) would allow users to "Install" it on their phones, offering a near-native experience without the complexity of building separate iOS/Android apps.
3. **Collaborative Features:** The standard database model makes it easy to add "Sharing" permissions. We could introduce "Shared Workspaces" or "Public Links," expanding the user base from individuals to teams and communities.
4. **Freemium Model:** The "Premium UI" suggests a premium product. There is an opportunity to introduce a subscription model offering advanced features like "Unlimited Storage," "Custom Themes," or "AI Credits," creating a sustainable revenue stream.

## IV. THREATS

In this section, we analyze external factors that could cause trouble for the app.

1. **Market Saturation:** The barrier to entry for note-taking apps is low. We are competing for attention against massive incumbents (Notion, Google Keep, Apple Notes) that offer deep ecosystem integration and are free to use. The app needs a strong unique selling point (USP) beyond just "looking good."
2. **Data Breach Risks:** By centralizing data, we create a "Honeypot" for attackers. If the database is compromised, thousands of private notes could be leaked. This carries significant reputational and legal risk compared to the decentralized/encrypted model.
3. **Browser Performance:** The "Glassmorphic" design relies heavily on CSS backdrop-filter and blur effects. These are computationally expensive. On older laptops or low-end Android phones, this could cause the app to feel sluggish or drain battery life, alienating users with older hardware.
4. **Platform Dependency:** Relying on third-party infrastructure (Render for hosting, Google for Auth, AWS/Cloudinary for media) exposes the app to "Platform Risk." Price hikes or service outages from these providers directly impact the app's viability and uptime.